

The Problem:

Matrix operations in quantum simulation involve:

- ### Four Parallelization Strategies:

A. SEQUENTIAL (Baseline)

How it works:

- Process one gate at a time, one row at a time
- No parallelization at all
- Like one chef making burgers one at a time

Simple Explanation:

"Do everything one step at a time. This is the baseline for comparison."

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"Do everything one step at a time. This is the baseline for comparison."

- Very small problems ($n < 6$)
- When OpenMP overhead > speedup benefit

How it works:

- Group gates into batches (e.g., 16 gates at once)
- Apply each batch to the state
- Uses the optimized simulator with truncation

"Instead of applying gates one-by-one, **collect multiple gates and apply them together** as a bigger operation. Like chopping all vegetables first, then cooking them all at once instead of chop-cook-chop-cook "

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B. BATCH Mode

How it works:

- Group gates into batches (e.g., 16 gates at once)
- Apply each batch to the state
- Uses the optimized simulator with truncation

Simple Explanation:

"Instead of applying gates one-by-one, **collect multiple gates and apply them together** as a bigger operation. Like chopping all vegetables first, then cooking them all at once instead of chop-cook-chop-cook."

Analogy:

- Bad: Apply gate 1 → truncate → apply gate 2 → truncate (slow!)
- BATCH: Apply gates 1-16 → truncate once (faster!)

When it's best:

- Medium problems ($8 \leq n < 10$)
- When truncation overhead is high

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Analogy:

- Bad: Apply gate 1 → truncate → apply gate 2 → truncate (slow!)
- BATCH: Apply gates 1-16 → truncate once (faster!)

When it's best:

- Medium problems ($8 \leq n < 10$)
- When truncation overhead is high
- When gates don't fuse well

C. ROW Mode

How it works:

1. Fuse consecutive gates on same qubit into one gate
(e.g., H-X-H on q0 → combined matrix)
2. Apply gate to L matrix with row-level parallelism
#pragma omp parallel for (over rows)

Simple Explanation:

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C. ROW Mode

How it works:

1. Fuse consecutive gates on same qubit into one gate
(e.g., H-X-H on q0 → combined matrix)

2. Apply gate to L matrix with row-level parallelism
#pragma omp parallel for (over rows)

Simple Explanation:

"First, **combine multiple gates into one bigger gate** (fusion). Then apply that gate by splitting the work across CPU cores - **each core handles different rows** of the matrix. Like having 8 chefs each make burgers for different tables."

Example (Gate Fusion):

Before fusion: $H \rightarrow X \rightarrow H$ on qubit 0

After fusion: Single matrix $M = H * X * H$

Benefit: Apply M once instead of H, then X, then H (3x faster!)

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```
L matrix (2^10 = 1024 rows):
- Thread 0: processes rows 0-127
- Thread 1: processes rows 128-255
- Thread 2: processes rows 256-383
... (8 threads total)
```

- Large problems ($n \geq 10$)
- Low-rank states ($\text{rank} \ll 2^n$) - typical for LRET!
- Sequential gates on same qubit (fuseable)

How it works:

- Apply gates with column-level parallelism

```
#pragma omp parallel for (over columns)
```

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D. COLUMN Mode

How it works:

- Apply gates with column-level parallelism
- #pragma omp parallel for (over columns)
- Each thread handles different columns

Simple Explanation:

"Like ROW mode, but **each CPU core handles different columns** instead of rows. This works better when the matrix has many columns (high-rank states)."

Visual:

```
L matrix (rows=1024, columns=64):  
  
ROW mode splits by rows:  
[Row 0-127 ] ← Thread 0  
[Row 128-255] ← Thread 1
```

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```
L matrix (rows=1024, columns=64):  
  
ROW mode splits by rows:  
[Row 0-127 ] ← Thread 0  
[Row 128-255] ← Thread 1  
...  
  
COLUMN mode splits by columns:  
[Col 0-7 | Col 8-15 | Col 16-23 | ...]  
  ↑       ↑       ↑  
Thread0  Thread1 Thread2
```

When it's best:

- High-rank states (rank >> 1)
- When `--initial-rank` is large
- When memory access patterns favor column-wise operations

F HYBRID Mode

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How it works:

1. Build "layers" of non-overlapping gates
Layer 1: [Gate on q0, Gate on q2, Gate on q4] (can run in parallel!)
Layer 2: [Gate on q1, Gate on q3]
2. Apply all gates in a layer simultaneously (layer parallelism)
3. Within each gate, use row/column parallelism

"Find gates that operate on **different qubits** and apply them **at the same time** (they don't interfere). Like having multiple chefs cook different dishes simultaneously - one makes burgers (q0), another makes pizza (q2), another makes salad (q4) - all at once!"

Circuit:

$$H(q_0) \rightarrow X(q_1) \rightarrow H(q_0) \rightarrow \text{CNOT}(q_0, q_1)$$

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Example:

Circuit:
H(q0) → X(q1) → H(q0) → CNOT(q0,q1)

Layers:
Layer 1: [H(q0), X(q1)] ← Applied in parallel (different qubits!)
Layer 2: [H(q0)] ← Must wait for Layer 1
Layer 3: [CNOT(q0,q1)] ← Must wait for Layer 2

When it's best:

- Deep circuits with many qubits
- Sparse gate placement (gates on different qubits)
- When you want to maximize CPU utilization

Performance Comparison Table:

Mode	Best For	Why	Typical Speedup
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When it's best:

- Deep circuits with many qubits
- Sparse gate placement (gates on different qubits)
- When you want to maximize CPU utilization

Performance Comparison Table:

Mode	Best For	Why	Typical Speedup
SEQUENTIAL	$n < 6$	OpenMP overhead too high	1.0x (baseline)
BATCH	$8 \leq n < 10$	Reduces truncation overhead	1.2-1.5x
ROW	$n \geq 10$, low rank	Row parallelism + fusion	2-4x
COLUMN	High rank states	Column parallelism	1.5-2.5x
HYBRID	Deep, sparse circuits	Layer + row/column parallelism	2-3x

Real-World Analogy Summary:

Mode	Restaurant Analogy
SEQUENTIAL	One chef makes one burger at a time

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